

PSB Staffing Numbers: Comparing Budget and DESE Reports

A short guide to the Brookline Public Schools staffing numbers that come up most often in budget discussions.

Several Brookline staffing figures circulate in budget conversations, and they can look contradictory at first glance. Most of the confusion comes from mixing reports that count different things.

DESE district-profile reports use narrower categories such as total enrollment, educator FTE, or teachers by program area. Brookline's FY27 school budget uses a broader staffing chart that counts all staff regardless of funding source.

That is why DESE can show about 54 special education teachers while the PSB budget shows 386.1 FTE in its broader Special Education category. The same caution applies to claims about administrators: the FY27 budget's 216.4 district-personnel figure is a district office staffing total, not a count of administrators alone.

Key point: numbers that look inconsistent are often counting different groups of people.

Comparison table

Approximate figures taken from DESE district profiles and the PSB FY27 budget.

Measure	Year	Number	What it appears to count
Total enrollment	2014-15	7,508	All students in district
Total enrollment	2024-25	7,023	All students in district
Projected enrollment	2026-27	6,989	PSB FY27 budget projection
Total educator FTE	2014-15	1,134.5	DESE educator count
Total educator FTE	2024-25	1,249.4	DESE educator count
Total staff FTE	2026-27	1,432.6	PSB all-staff budget count
School personnel	2026-27	1,216.3	PSB budget category
District personnel	2026-27	216.4	District-office staffing, not just administrators
Special education teachers	2024-25	54.0	DESE teacher-by-program-area count
Special Education	2026-27	386.1	PSB broader special education staffing category
Related Services	2026-27	67.2	Separate PSB staffing category
Office of Student Services	2026-27	28.6	Separate PSB district-office category

Sources

- DESE enrollment 2014-15:
profiles.doe.mass.edu/profiles/student.aspx?dropDownOrgCode=2&fycode=2015&orgcode=00460000&orgtypecode=5
- DESE enrollment 2024-25:
profiles.doe.mass.edu/profiles/student.aspx?dropDownOrgCode=2&fycode=2025&orgcode=00460000&orgtypecode=5
- DESE educator FTE 2014-15:
profiles.doe.mass.edu/profiles/teacher.aspx?dropDownOrgCode=2&fycode=2015&leftNavId=828&orgcode=00460000&orgtypecode=5
- DESE educator FTE 2024-25:
profiles.doe.mass.edu/profiles/teacher.aspx?dropDownOrgCode=2&fycode=2025&leftNavId=828&orgcode=00460000&orgtypecode=5
- DESE teacher by program area, 2024-25:
profiles.doe.mass.edu/profiles/teacher.aspx?fycode=2025&leftNavId=830&orgcode=00460000&orgtypecode=5
- FY27 Schools Proposed Budget: local file in BF/docs/FY27 Schools Proposed Budget 2.5.26.pdf
- PSB Budget Management page:
psbma.org/district/administration-finance/administration-finance-home/budget-central/budget-management